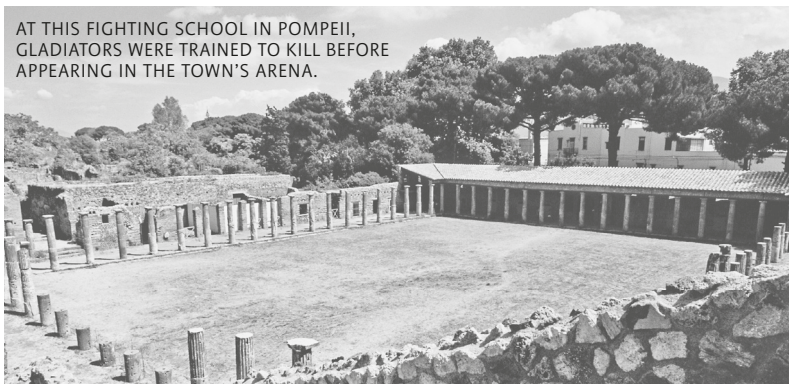


AT THIS FIGHTING SCHOOL IN POMPEII, GLADIATORS WERE TRAINED TO KILL BEFORE APPEARING IN THE TOWN'S ARENA.



He disapproved of women working as gladiators. The rest of Roman society, however, enjoyed their deadly duels.

Schools for gladiators

Some people made money off of gladiators. They were called *lanistae* and became managers for groups of fighters, hiring them out for fights in return for money. Some *lanistae* became very wealthy doing this.

Gladiators were taught the craft of killing at special schools called *ludi*. They were large, well-run places, like army camps. The trainees lived in barracks and were usually only allowed out of the school when they had to appear in a contest. Discipline was strict, and those who broke the rules were punished by being sent to the school's prison.

Sick or injured fighters were no use to anyone, so trainee gladiators were well looked after. They were given plenty of boiled beans and starchy barley to eat—foods that filled them up and made their muscles strong. (Gladiators were nicknamed *hordearii*, meaning "barley eaters.") Their health was just as important as their

